Northgate Insurance

Home Insurance Policy Wording

Document type: Policy Wording | Product: Home

Reference: NG-HOME-PW-2026 | Effective from 1 January 2026

Thank you for choosing Northgate Insurance. This policy wording, together with your schedule and any endorsements, forms your contract of insurance. Please read it carefully and keep it somewhere safe.

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1. About your policy

This policy is underwritten by Northgate Insurance plc. In return for your premium, we will provide the cover described in this wording for the sections shown as active in your schedule, during the period of insurance.

Words shown in bold in the original wording have the meanings given in section 2 (Definitions) wherever they appear.

2. Definitions

2.1 Buildings

The home, its permanent fixtures and fittings, garages and outbuildings, swimming pools, tennis courts, drives, patios, paths, walls, gates and fences, all within the boundary of the property shown in your schedule.

2.2 Contents

Household goods and personal possessions which belong to you or for which you are legally responsible, kept in the home. Contents does not include motor vehicles, caravans, boats, or any part of the buildings.

2.3 Escape of water

Water or oil escaping from any fixed water or heating installation, washing machine, dishwasher, fridge or freezer, or fish tank.

2.4 Excess

The amount you must pay towards each claim, as set out in section 7.

2.5 Unoccupied

The home is not lived in by you or a member of your family for more than 60 consecutive days. Living in means sleeping in the home overnight.

2.6 Valuables

Jewellery, watches, items of gold, silver or other precious metals, works of art, collections of stamps, coins or medals, and furs.

2.7 Period of insurance

The period shown in your schedule, normally 12 months.

3. General conditions

3.1 Reasonable care

You must take all reasonable steps to prevent loss or damage and keep the buildings in a good state of repair. We will not pay claims where loss or damage results from a failure to maintain the home.

3.2 Changes in circumstances

You must tell us as soon as possible about any change which may affect your cover, including structural alterations, the home becoming unoccupied, or anyone in the home receiving a criminal conviction.

3.3 Unoccupancy

If the home is unoccupied, cover for theft, attempted theft, escape of water and malicious damage stops from the 61st day of unoccupancy until the home is lived in again, unless we have agreed otherwise in writing.

3.4 Fraud

If any claim is fraudulent or exaggerated, we will not pay the claim, we may cancel the policy from the date of the fraudulent act, and we may report the matter to the police.

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3.5 Cancellation by you

You may cancel within 14 days of receiving your documents and receive a full refund if no claim has been made. After this cooling-off period you may cancel at any time and we will refund the premium for the unexpired period, less an administration fee of £25.

3.6 Cancellation by us

We may cancel this policy by giving you at least 7 days' notice in writing, for example if you fail to pay your premium or provide information we have reasonably requested.

4. Section A - Buildings

We will pay for loss of or damage to the buildings caused by any of the following insured events during the period of insurance.

Insured event	What is not covered
Fire, smoke, explosion, lightning or earthquake	Damage caused by smoke from fireplaces or gradual exposure to smoke
Storm or flood	Damage to fences, gates and hedges; damage caused by rising groundwater alone
Escape of water	Damage to the installation itself; damage while the home is unoccupied
Theft or attempted theft	Theft while the home is lent, let or sublet, unless by forcible entry
Subsidence, heave or landslip	Damage to drives, patios and paths unless the main building is also damaged
Impact by vehicles, aircraft or animals	Damage caused by pets
Falling trees, aerials or satellite dishes	The cost of removing a fallen tree that has not damaged the buildings

4.1 Alternative accommodation

If your home cannot be lived in following damage covered by this section, we will pay the reasonable cost of comparable alternative accommodation for you, your family and your pets, up to 20% of the buildings sum insured.

4.2 Trace and access

We will pay up to £5,000 for the cost of finding the source of an escape of water or oil which causes damage to the buildings, and for making good the damage caused in finding it.

4.3 Accidental damage to buildings (optional)

If your schedule shows that accidental damage cover applies, we will also pay for sudden and unexpected damage to the buildings caused by an external means, such as putting a foot through a ceiling while in the loft.

4.4 How we settle buildings claims

We will pay the cost of repair or rebuilding to the same standard, but not better, provided the buildings were in a good state of repair. If the buildings sum insured is less than the full rebuilding cost, we may reduce the amount we pay in proportion.

5. Section B - Contents

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We will pay for loss of or damage to your contents in the home caused by any of the insured events listed in Section A. The following limits apply.

Item	Limit
Any single valuable (unless specified)	£2,000
All valuables in total	30% of contents sum insured
Cash and bank notes	£500
Contents temporarily in the garden	£1,000
Food in a fridge or freezer spoiled by breakdown or power failure	£500
Students' belongings at a term-time address	£5,000

5.1 Replacement as new

We will replace items as new, except for clothing and household linen, where we will deduct an amount for wear and tear.

5.2 Specified items

Any valuable worth more than £2,000 must be listed on your schedule as a specified item, supported by a valuation dated within the last 3 years. Unspecified items above this value will only be covered up to £2,000.

6. Section C - Personal possessions away from the home (optional)

If your schedule shows this cover applies, we will pay for loss of or damage to your personal possessions anywhere in the world for up to 60 days in any period of insurance. The limit for any single item is £1,500 and for cash is £250.

7. Excesses

You must pay the following amount towards each claim. If more than one excess applies to a single incident, only the highest excess will be applied.

Type of claim	Excess
Standard excess (all claims unless stated below)	£250
Escape of water	£500
Subsidence, heave or landslip	£1,000
Accidental damage (optional cover)	£250
Personal possessions away from the home	£100

8. General exclusions

These exclusions apply to all sections of the policy.

- Wear and tear, gradual deterioration, rot, mould or rust.
- Damage caused by insects, vermin, birds or pets.
- Faulty design, workmanship or materials.
- War, terrorism, riot outside the UK, or nuclear contamination.

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- Loss of data or damage caused by computer viruses or cyber attack.
- Any loss that happened before the policy started.
- Pressure waves from aircraft travelling at or above the speed of sound.

9. How to make a claim

9.1 Telling us about a claim

Call our claims line on 0800 000 0101, available 24 hours a day, or report online. You must tell us about any claim within 30 days of discovering the loss or damage.

9.2 Theft and malicious damage

You must report theft, attempted theft or malicious damage to the police within 48 hours of discovery and obtain a crime reference number.

9.3 Emergency repairs

You may carry out emergency repairs to prevent further damage, up to £1,000, without asking us first. Keep the receipts and any damaged items for inspection.

9.4 Evidence

We may ask for receipts, photographs, valuations or estimates to support your claim.

10. Complaints

If you are unhappy with our service, please contact our Customer Relations team. We will acknowledge your complaint within 5 working days and aim to resolve it within 8 weeks. If you are not satisfied with our final response, or we have not responded within 8 weeks, you may refer your complaint to the Financial Ombudsman Service.

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